Revision Date:
July 1, 2024

Background:
Necessary supportive services must be available to every CalWORKs (CW) recipient participating in approved Employment Services (ES) activities. Participants will have good cause for not participating if supportive services are not available.

Purpose:
The purpose of this revision is to add eligibility factors for ancillary payments for qualifying ES participants enrolled in Self-Employment.

Policy:
Payment for supportive services must be made as soon as possible to allow for the individual's participation in assigned ES activities. Payments, except for child care, will be advanced so that personal funds are not used to pay for ES related expenses.

Supportive Service Types
Supportive Services include ancillary, transportation and child care expenses. Specific policies related to child care are provided in CalWORKs Program Guide (CPG) section 10-010. Supportive services are also issued under the following circumstances:

Transportation Costs

Circumstance	Description
Child Care for ES Sanctioned Individuals (who do not request to cure their sanction)	ES sanctioned individuals are potentially eligible for child care assistance if they have received CW in the last 24 months.
Participation to Cure a Sanction	Supportive services may be authorized as needed for a sanctioned CW recipient who wants to participate in ES activities to cure a sanction.
Voluntary Participant (Exempt/Excused 2nd Parent)	Supportive services may be authorized as needed for a voluntary ES participant.
Failure to Provide Verification of Attendance or Satisfactory Progress	Supportive services cannot be withheld pending verification of attendance or satisfactory progress in an assigned ES activity.
Supportive Services Pending an Appeal	Participants are not entitled to a continuation of supportive services in the same amount or from pending a hearing decision. Participants are entitled to supportive services only at the level and in the form authorized by the Appeals decision.

Reasonable transportation costs are paid to a participant as needed for the following:
- Travel to/from approved ES and Family Stabilization activities
- Travel for both the parent and children to/from child care providers

- Parking fees

Ancillary Expenses
Ancillary payments cover approved expenses other than child care and transportation. All ancillary expenses must be required, necessary and reasonable for the individual to participate in assigned ES activities and/or to accept/retain employment.

Ancillary Expenses for Postsecondary Educational Programs
ES participants who are enrolled full time or part time in a publicly funded postsecondary educational program will receive an advanced standard payment (ASP) for books and college supplies prior to the start of the academic period. ES participants may also request an advanced payment or reimbursement for the actual costs of educational expenses exceeding the ASP.

Ancillary Expenses for Self-Employment
Participants assigned to Self-Employment may be eligible to receive one-time basic ancillary start-up expenses required to do their job. However, ES is not obligated to pay all costs incurred by a participant when starting a business. Ancillary expenses may include, but are not limited to, tools, clothing, licensing, permitting and other fees and expenses necessary for self-employed participants to comply with local operating requirements.

Student Financial Aid Statement
Participants who receive financial aid for attendance in education and/or training programs may choose to receive ancillary supportive services payments for school-related costs such as supplies and books, even though the financial aid may include funds for those items. Employment Case Managers (ECMs) are required to obtain a signed Student Financial Aid Statement (WTW8) from all ES participants in approved educational or training activities to ensure that they are adequately informed of their rights and responsibilities regarding financial aid and supportive services.

Disability Accommodations
Ancillary supportive services must be issued to provide reasonable accommodations when necessary for individuals to participate on an equal basis with non-disabled participants in approved ES activities. Disabled individuals who request accommodations are not required to disclose their diagnosis, but only to verify the nature and extent of their disability.

Diaper Supportive Services
Assistance with diaper costs is considered a necessary supportive service to ensure ES participation of eligible families. Qualifying ES participants will receive diaper supportive services each month as an advanced ancillary payment for each child who is under 36 months of age meeting eligibility criteria. Participants will have good cause for not participating if diaper supportive services are not provided in advance of an assigned ES activity, and the lack of advanced supportive services impacted participation.
To be eligible for diaper supportive services, ES participants must:
1. Have a child who is under 36 months of age at the beginning of the month and is receiving CW assistance or ineligible to receive cash aid but under the primary responsibility, care and control of the ES participant. The ineligible child must be linked to the Assistance Unit (AU) and living in the home.

Examples: Sibling or half-sibling ineligible to receive cash aid due to undocumented status, receipt of Social Security Income (SSI/SSP), no deprivation due to either parent in the home working sufficient hours per CW requirements, children who are otherwise eligible but cannot be added to the AU until the next CW payment period

2. Be a mandatory or voluntary ES participant in good standing with program requirements, actively participating or waiting to be engaged in ES program activities

Diaper supportive services may also be issued for participants who are:
1. In noncompliance and not yet financially sanctioned or removed from aid
2. Determined to have good cause for not meeting monthly participation requirements
3. In the process of curing a sanction or removal from cash aid
4. Exempt from ES but participating voluntarily
5. Excused 2nd Parents but participating voluntarily

Diaper supportive services will <u>not</u> be issued to individuals who are:
1. Financially sanctioned or removed from cash aid and not in the process of curing the sanction/removal from cash aid
2. Exempt from ES and not participating voluntarily
3. Excused 2nd parents and not participating voluntarily
4. CW ineligible and only receiving cash aid for an eligible child (Child Only AU)
5. Receiving cash aid in a Pregnant Woman Only AU with no eligible children in the home
6. In an AU with a child not aided due to parent's failure to report birth of the child within required reporting timeframes and/or provide verifications required to add the child to the CW case

Diaper supportive services will continue to be advanced until the first of the month in which the child reaches 36 months of age. Diaper supportive services will be discontinued if the participant opts out of the payment or is no longer eligible.

<u>Notification Requirements</u>
A timely Notice of Action (NOA) is required to be issued for supportive service approvals, denials and/or payment changes. When denying, decreasing, or discontinuing supportive services, a NOA must be issued at least ten calendar days prior to the effective date of the change. The ten days does not include the day the NOA is mailed or the effective date. A NOA is not required for approval of supportive services for one-time, short-term activities, such as Orientation/Appraisal. ES participants are required to notify their ECM at least ten calendar days before any anticipated changes affecting supportive services, except in emergency or exceptional situations.

<u>Procedure</u>:
Processing Guides 10-011.A1; 10-011.A2; Appendix A 10-011.A2

<u>References</u>:
- MPP 42-750
- ACL 03-15; ACL18-38; ACL 21-04, ACL 22-80

Sunset Date:

This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by July 31, 2027

Approval for Release:



Rick Wanne, Director
Self-Sufficiency Services